

Lord, I want to be a Christian

Text: African-American spiritual, *Folk Songs...* 1907

Music: African-American spiritual, *Folk Songs...* 1907

LORD, I WANT TO BE irregular

1 Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart, in my heart.
2 Lord, I want to be more lov - ing...
3 Lord, I want to be more ho - ly...
4 Lord, I want to be like Je - sus...

Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.

In my heart, in my heart,

Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.

The musical score is written in 4/4 time with a key signature of two flats (Bb and Eb). It consists of four staves of music. The first staff contains four lines of lyrics, each corresponding to a different melody line. The second staff continues the melody with the lyrics 'Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.' The third staff features a melodic phrase with the lyrics 'In my heart, in my heart,'. The fourth staff concludes the piece with the lyrics 'Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.' The music is characterized by its simple, folk-like melody and the use of irregular phrasing, as indicated by the 'irregular' note in the text.